Washington's amazement).[79] Such arming, however, created considerable concern in Kabul, which was fighting a covert war with Pakistan. Daud complained to the Indian leadership that 'the recent lifting of an arms embargo to Pakistan by the US government [at a] time that Pakistan is engaged in shedding blood in Balochistan and Pashtunistan, has caused grave concern to the people and Government of Afghanistan. It will lead to imbalance in the region and promote an armaments race and would create an additional threat to peace in the region'.[80] For all practical reasons, Afghanistan needed the Soviet Union and India's proactive military support. Even though, arguably, India's military aid potential was highly limited in 1970s and could have made little strategic (though symbolically potent) impact, worries about Pakistan's balkanisation and India's domestic political situation did not permit adventurism. In 1976, Indira Gandhi visited Kabul to consolidate ties and offered more economic assistance, but Daud's request for military support was politely refused.[81]

India's concern about Daud's covert military campaign and its regional repercussions were not entirely unfounded. Bhutto responded to Daud's sponsoring of the BPLF and the Pashtun separatists by offering anti-Kabul Afghan Islamists sanctuary in Pakistan through Pakistan's secret services, the Directorate of Inter-Service Intelligence (ISI). Just like the evolution of the left-wing groups such as the *Parcham* (flag), the *Khalq* (people), the Maoist *Shola-e-Javed* (eternal flame), and other minor groups such as the *Setam-e-Milli* (Oppressed Nation), the *Sada-e-Awam* (Voice of the Masses), the *Tolan-Pal Moleswak* (Afghan Social Democratic Party), the *Afghan Mellat*, and the *Mossawat* (Equality), Afghanistan also witnessed the rise of the Islamic right (both Shia and Sunni) in the mid-1960s and early 1970s.[82] Inspired by the Muslim Brotherhood or the *Ikhwanin-ul-Muslimin*, the Sunni Islamist groups were led by Kabul university professors who had completed their education at the al-Azhar in Cairo. From these circles emerged the 'Muslim Youth' or the *Sazman-e-Jawanan-e-Muslimin* in 1969 that became the *Jami'at-e-Islami* (Islamic Society) in 1973—of which Ahmad Shah Massoud, Burhanuddin Rabbani, and Gulbuddin Hekmatyar were part.[83] At the same time, the *Khuddam-ul-Forqan* (Servants of Providence) emerged from within the Afghan Ulema under the watch of Ibrahim Mojaddedi. In addition to the Sunni right-wing resistance